O-W-0035 (GSA-FSS)
August 4, 1954

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

WASH, BLANKET AND ROLLER, FOR OFFSET DUPLICATING PROCESS

This Interim Federal Specification has been developed for use in immediate procurement by the General Services Administration and has not been coordinated with other Federal agencies, except the Government Printing Office, or with industry. It has not been approved for promulgation as a Federal Specification and is subject to modification. Other Federal agencies are urged to use this specification in procurement and to forward comments to the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Standards Division, Washington 25, D. C.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. - The blanket and roller wash described herein is intended for use in washing and cleaning rubber blankets and rubber rollers of offset duplicating presses.

1.2 Classification (type and grade). - This specification covers only one type and grade of blanket and roller wash.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS

2.1 The following Federal Specification, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, forms a part of this specification:

VV-L-791--Lubricants, Liquid Fuels and Related Products; Methods of Inspection, Sampling, and Testing.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under "General Information" in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the GSA Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. - The blanket and roller wash shall consist of a volatile solvent or solvents which will easily remove printing ink from the rubber blanket and rollers without leaving a residue which will interfere with the normal operation of the press. The wash shall not contain chlorinated solvents and any materials which would be injurious to the health of the operator.

3.2 Drying time. - The wash shall dry rapidly without leaving residue as specified in paragraph 3.3, so that it does not interfere with the normal running of the press.

3.3 Residue. - The wash shall be volatile and after evaporation shall not leave an oily or dry residue which will interfere with the normal running of the printing operation.

3.4 Water. - The wash shall show no turbidity when tested in accordance with paragraph 4.2.3.

3.5 Corrosion. - A clean copper strip shall show not more than an extremely slight discoloration when completely immersed in the boiling wash for 30 minutes as specified in paragraph 4.2.4.

3.6 Distillation. - When a sample of the wash is distilled in accordance with paragraph 4.2.5, not less than 50 percent shall be recovered in the receiver when the thermometer reads 350° F. and not less than 90 percent when the thermometer reads 375° F. The end point (maximum distillation temperature) shall be not higher than 410° F.

3.6.1 Distillation residue. - When a sample of the wash is distilled in accordance with paragraph 4.2.5, the residue shall be not more than 1.5 percent. (See par. 4.2.5.1.)

3.7 Odor. - The odor (original and residual) of the wash shall at no time have an unpleasant or rancid odor. (See par. 4.2.6.)

3.8 Swelling and separation of rubber parts. - The wash shall not cause the rubber blanket or rubber rollers of the press to swell in such a manner as to distort the blanket. The wash shall not cause the rubber face of the blanket to separate from the cloth backing. Any separation of the rubber blanket from the cloth backing shall be cause for rejection of the wash. (See par. 4.2.7.)

3.9 Flash point. - The flash point shall be not less than 100° F. (Tag closed tester). (See par. 4.2.8.)

3.10 Ink removal. - The wash shall remove dried ink with a minimum of effort.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling. - One unit or one quart of the blanket or roller wash shall be taken from each delivery.

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4.2 Inspection and tests.

4.2.1 Drying time. - Saturate a wad of cheese-cloth with blanket and roller wash and rub up a rubber press blanket in the normal manner. Examine for rapidity of evaporation of the wash and for residue. (See 4.2.6.)

4.2.2 Residue. - Evaporate 100 ml. of the sample wash in a flat dish at room temperature. Examine for either dry or oily residue.

4.2.3 Water. - Place 5 ml. of the sample wash in a glass stoppered cylinder and add 25 ml. of 60° A. P. I. gasoline in 5-ml. portions, thoroughly shaking after each addition. The test shall be conducted at 20° to 25° C. and then examined for turbidity.

4.2.4 Corrosion. - Place a clean strip of mechanically polished pure sheet copper, about 1/2 inch wide and 3 inches long, in a glass tube about 3/4 inch in diameter and 18 inches long. Add sufficient wash to completely cover the strip and heat in an oil bath maintained at a temperature which permits the solvent to reflux within the tube. Maintain at this temperature for 30 minutes. Remove the strip from the solvent and examine for discoloration. A marked blackening or iridescence (a slight tarnish may be disregarded) of the copper strip shall be considered as failure to meet the requirements of this specification.

4.2.5 Distillation. - Test for distillation shall be conducted in accordance with Method 1001.7 of Federal Specification VV-L-791.

4.2.5.1 Distillation residue. - The residue after distillation shall be determined as described in Method 1001.7 of Federal Specification VV-L-791.

4.2.6 Odor (original and residual). - Determine the odor of the wash during the drying time specified in 4.2.1. The original odor may be observed while saturating the cheesecloth. Residual odor may be determined after the cheesecloth hasb een allowed to dry or by observing the blanket after washing.

4.2.7 Swelling of rubber blankets or rollers. - Using a micrometer, measure the thickness at the four corners and center of a 6-inch square specimen of rubber blanket. Completely immerse the specimen in the sample wash for 24 hours. Wipe the specimen dry and again measure the thickness at the same places. Examine for distortion and separation.

4.2.8 Flash point (Tag closed tester) shall be determined in accordance with Method 1101.4 of Federal Specification VV-L-791.

4.2.9 Ink removal. - Prepare a press blanket by covering the rubber printing surface with a standard black offset printing ink. Apply the ink by spreading it uniformly over the surface with a hand ink roller. Allow the ink to remain on the rubber blanket for 24 hours. At the end of this time, wash up the blanket, using the sample wash. The dried ink must leave the blanket with a minimum of effort as heretofore specified in paragraph 3.10 and shall not require hard rubbing or scraping.

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4.2.10 Chlorinated solvents. - The Beilstein test for halogens shall be conducted.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. - The size of containers (i.e., quarts, gallons, or other size of containers) shall be specified by the procuring officer; otherwise commercial packages will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. - The subject commodity shall be prepared for shipment to permit acceptance by carrier for transportation at the lowest applicable rate, and to afford maximum protection from normal hazards of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Issue packages. - Unless otherwise specified, each issue package shall be marked with the name of the material and the quantity contained therein, as defined by the contract or order under which the shipment is made, the name of the contractor, and the number of the contract or order.

5.3.2 Shipping containers. - Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the material and the quantity contained therein, as defined by the contract or order under which the shipment is made, the name of the contractor, the number of the contract or order, the name and address of the consignee, and the gross weight.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. - Purchasers should specify size of packaging container required and exercise any desired options offered herein. (See 5.1, 5.3.1, and 5.3.2.)

Patent notice. - The furnishing by the Government of specifications, including drawings or other data in connection therewith, does not in any way grant the recipient of such material, or any other person, a license or right to manufacture, use, or sell any patented or unpatented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

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